EDUCATOR KIT · CHEAT-SHEET

Seven methods

We don't give you the file. We teach you to build it.

METHOD 01

FIND

How to find any answer

Most people search like a customer. Professionals search like an operator.

Go to the primary source first. The official docs, the actual job post, the company's own site. Not a blog summarizing it, not a reaction video. Primary sources are more accurate and usually faster.

Search like an operator. Use exact phrases in quotes. Narrow to a site (site:linkedin.com), a file type (filetype:pdf), a date range. Subtract noise with a minus sign. A precise query beats an hour of scrolling.

Triangulate before you trust. Three independent sources agreeing beats one confident source. If only one place says it, treat it as a rumour.

Check recency and incentive. Ask two questions of everything you read: When was this true? And who profits if I believe it?

> DRILL Pick something you don't know, a tool, a rate, a process. Find a trustworthy answer in under 10 minutes using only primary sources. Write down the query that worked.

METHOD 02

DECONSTRUCT

How to build something you've never built

You never need a template. You need five examples and the ability to see the pattern.

Collect five real examples. Real ones, made by professionals, for the real situation. Not five templates, five artifacts that worked.

Extract the skeleton. List what every single example contains. That common structure is not a style choice, it's the function. That's your skeleton.

Name the variables. Note what changes between examples. Those differences are the judgment calls you'll have to make. Understand why each one was made.

Write the rules. Turn what you saw into explicit rules: 'every bullet contains a measurable result', 'the summary names the target role'. Now you have a method, not a copy.

Build from the rules. Blank page. Apply your rules. What comes out is yours, and it fits your situation, which no template ever could.

> DRILL Take any deliverable you've never made. Find five real ones. Produce a written list of rules. Build yours from the rules alone, with the examples closed.

METHOD 03

LEARN

How to teach yourself any skill, fast

Courses are optional. The ability to learn without one is not.

Define the outcome, not the topic. Not 'learn QuickBooks'. Instead: 'reconcile a month of transactions for a real business without help'. An outcome tells you when you're done.

Find the 20% that does 80% of the job. Every tool has a handful of functions used daily and hundreds used never. Look at real job posts and real workflows to find which is which. Learn those first.

Build a real artifact immediately. Don't watch six hours of tutorial. Watch twenty minutes, then produce something real and flawed. The flaws tell you exactly what to learn next.

Get feedback that stings a little. Show it to someone who'll be honest, or have AI critique it against the rules you wrote. Comfortable feedback teaches nothing.

Teach it back. Explain it to another beginner, or write the SOP. If you can't explain it simply, you have a gap, and now you know exactly where.

> DRILL Pick one tool from your niche. In 48 hours, produce one real artifact with it and write a one-page SOP teaching someone else to do the same.

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METHOD 04

VET

How to judge information, tools, and opportunities

Confidence is not accuracy, and advice often arrives with an incentive attached. Learn to check both.

Who benefits if I believe this?. Follow the incentive. A recommendation that profits the recommender needs outside evidence.

Is this evidence, or is this vibes?. Numbers, sources, and dates are evidence. Confidence, screenshots, and lifestyle are not.

Is it still true?. Platform rules, rates, and tools change yearly. A five-year-old answer about this year's hiring is a guess wearing a suit.

Run the red-flag check. Upfront fees, guaranteed income, secrecy, urgency, and vagueness about the actual work are the five signals of a scam or a bad client. Any one of them is a stop.

> DRILL Take any opportunity or course you're considering. Run it through the four questions in writing. If you can't produce evidence for it, don't act on it.

METHOD 05

ASK

How to ask a question that gets answered

A well-formed question gets a professional's help. A vague one gets ignored, everywhere.

Show what you're trying to do. State the actual goal, not the symptom. 'I'm trying to reconcile March' beats 'it's not working'.

Show what you already tried. This proves you respect the other person's time, and it eliminates the first five things they'd suggest.

Show what happened, exactly. The literal error, the literal reply, the literal number. Not your paraphrase of it.

Ask for the method, not the file. 'Can you send me the file' gets you a file at best. 'How would you approach this' makes you a colleague, and teaches you something you keep.

> DRILL Rewrite the last question you asked anyone into this four-part form. Notice how often you can now answer it yourself.

METHOD 06

UNSTICK

How to get yourself moving again

Every professional is stuck most of the day. They just have a procedure.

Re-read the actual requirement. A surprising share of 'stuck' is solving the wrong problem. Read what was asked, word for word.

Shrink it to the smallest failing piece. Cut the problem in half until you find the exact point where it breaks. Vague problems are unsolvable; small ones are trivial.

Change one thing at a time. Change two and you learn nothing from the result. Slow is fast.

Explain it out loud. Say the problem aloud to a wall, a friend, or an AI. The act of forming the sentence solves it more often than you'd believe.

Time-box, then ask well. Give yourself a hard limit, say 45 minutes. If you're still stuck, stop grinding and ask, using the ASK method. Grinding past the limit is ego, not work.

> DRILL Next time you're stuck, run the five steps in order and write down which one freed you. Within a month you'll know your own failure pattern.

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METHOD 07

GIVE

How to grow by giving first

The fastest way into any ecosystem is to put value into it before you ask anything from it.

Do real work for a real need, at no cost. One scoped pro-bono project for a school, parish, co-op, or small business. Choose where your hours do the most good: a small organization gains more from ten of your hours than a big one ever would.

Teach what you just learned. Write the guide you wish existed when you were stuck, and post it where the next beginner will find it. Teaching is also the strongest test of understanding: see LEARN.

Share the method, not just the win. When something works (a message that got a reply, a workflow that saved hours), share how it worked. Wins impress people. Methods help them.

Show up in your niche's rooms. Answer real questions in the communities where your niche gathers. In six months you are the person people tag, and referrals start arriving before job posts do.

> DRILL This week: one hour of scoped, no-cost help for one real person or organization, and one written answer to a beginner's question in a community you belong to. Notice what both cost you, almost nothing. Notice what they start.

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